



Tanzania Film Festival 2025

14th - 16th August

Prepared by
Studio 19 Limited

#TAFFA2025





Executive Summary

The Tanzania Film Festival (TAFFA 2025), held in collaboration with **the Mashariki Creative Economy Expo**, firmly positioned Tanzania as a dynamic hub for film, creativity, and cultural exchange. The Festival and Expo, took place at the Mlimani City, Dar es Salaam, the three-day event (14th - 16th August) marked a defining milestone for the nation's creative industries, bringing together diverse stakeholders from film, arts, culture and the broader creative economy.

Festival Highlights

- **545 total participants** in pre-festival activities and a 15+ event series
- **437 film submissions** and **30 selected films**
- **Participation:** Over 1,600 attendees including filmmakers, industry professionals, cultural leaders, youth, and international guests.
- **Screenings:** More than 30 films from Tanzania and across Africa showcased the diversity and depth of regional storytelling.
- **Panels & Workshops:** 16+ sessions with 48 speakers, exploring themes of storytelling, digital transformation, financing, policy, and emerging technologies such as AI and VR.
- **Exhibitions:** The Expo and Festival brought together 60+ exhibitors, highlighting innovations across creative industries, from animation and music to design and media.

We extend our heartfelt gratitude to our media partner Azam Media and to all our partners, whose support and collaboration made TAFFA 2025 possible. Your contributions brought this vision to life and continue to power the growth of Tanzania's creative industries.

Prepared for
Studio 19 Limited

Photos
Festival & Expo Photos

About Organizers

The Tanzania Film Festival is the biggest film event in Tanzania organized in collaboration between **The Tanzania Film Board (TFB)** and **Studio 19 Limited**.

The Tanzania Film Board (TFB)

The Tanzania Film Board (TFB), is a government regulatory body under the Ministry of Information, Communication, and Information Technology. It is responsible for overseeing, regulating, and promoting the film industry in Tanzania. The Board classifies and approves films, ensuring they align with the country's cultural, moral, and legal standards. Additionally, it supports the growth of local talent and the industry by fostering the production of films that showcase Tanzanian culture and values, while also facilitating international collaborations to enhance the global reach of Tanzania's film industry.

Studio 19 Limited

Studio 19 Limited is a full-service, creative agency founded in 2015 in Tanzania. From our beginnings to date, our efforts have always been fueled by three main passions: To tell good stories, to get them to the right people, and to transform people's lives. We believe in the transformative power of stories and we seek to enlighten, entertain and inspire. Our stories challenge assumptions, raise awareness, re-orient people's perspectives and focus energies towards transformation.

Culture and Development East Africa (CDEA)

The Mashariki Creative Economy Expo is organised by CDEA, a creative think tank based in Dar es Salaam. Incorporated in 2011, CDEA provides cultural and Pan-African thought leadership for creative, social and scientific innovators. It supports artists, cultural leaders and entrepreneurs across East Africa, promoting cultural values as a driver of development and uses incubation, research, advocacy and capacity-building programmes to stimulate creativity and encourage sustainable production and lifestyle

TAFFA in Numbers



The Expo and TAFFA was attended by Participants from Tanzania, Democratic Republic of Congo, Rwanda, Somalia, Kenya, Uganda, Zambia, Switzerland and The United States

Event Achievements



Pre - Festival
Attendees

545



Festival Attendances

1,613



Countries
Represented

9



Film Pitches

5



Instagram
Audience Reach

1M+



Instagram
Interactions

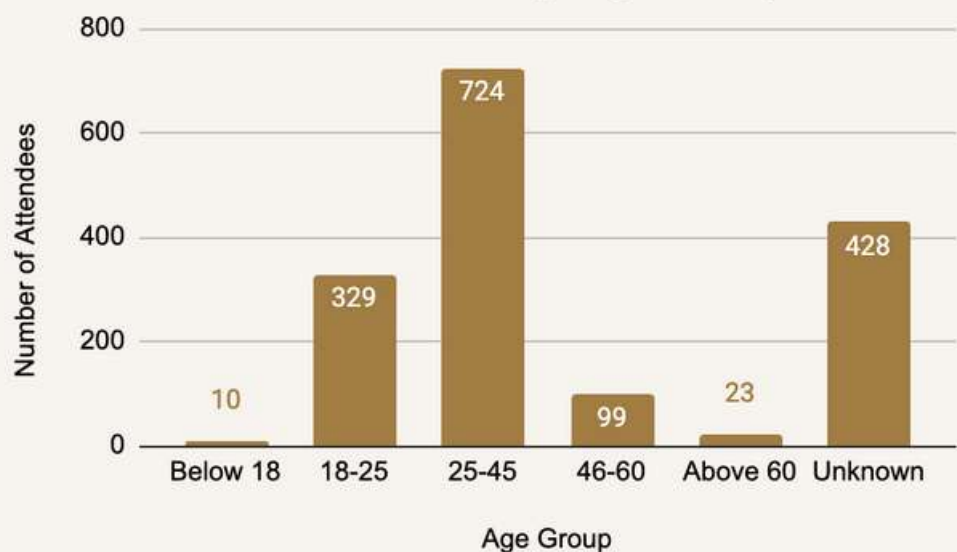
23.8K



New Instagram
Followers

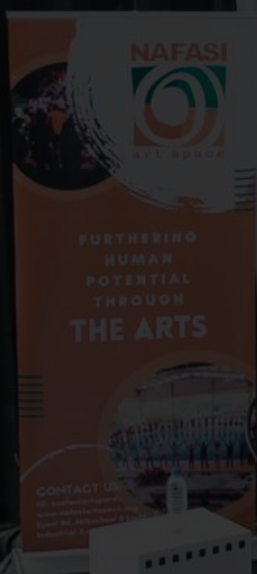
+1,457

Distribution of Attendees by Age Group



We are thankful to our various partners and sponsors





Pre Festival Activities

Pre - Festival Achievements

Leading up to the Tanzania Film Festival, a series of capacity-building activities, workshops, screenings, and dialogues were organized across Dar es Salaam. These programs not only built momentum but also empowered filmmakers, engaged communities, and amplified the visibility of the Festival.

Key Numbers at a Glance

- **Total Participants:** 545 (248 male, 225 female, 72 not recorded)
- **Number of Activities Held:** 15+ across diverse themes
- **Range of Formats:** Public launch, panels, workshops, screenings, school dialogues, and masterclasses
- **Facilitators & Partners:** 25+ experts including filmmakers, trainers, academics, and industry professionals

Highlights of the Build-Up

- **Skill-Building Workshops:**
 - **Scriptwriting Series** (9–17 July) trained over 50 participants with facilitators from Nafasi Film Club and Tanzania Scriptwriters Association.
 - Technical Training including a **Camera Masterclass, Set Design,** and **Stop Animation labs** attracted enthusiastic emerging creatives.
- **Thematic Engagements:**
 - **Finding Funds for Films** workshop tackled financing challenges.
 - **Film in Health** session bridged cinema and public health with medical and creative experts.
- **Community Impact:**
 - **Film Screening and Dialogue** at Kibasila Secondary School (25th July) reached 232 students, making it one of the most impactful sessions in terms of youth engagement.
- **Innovation & Storytelling:**
 - **Impact Film Lab** and Stop Animation Workshops introduced young talents to experimental and impactful storytelling methods.

Pre Festival Activities



2nd July

Public Launch

The session, held at the British Council, introduced our partners and program, while also engaging stakeholders on how they could take part in the Road to TAFFA. It was broadcast live by Azam, our main media sponsor.

Attendance **59**

3rd July

Panel on Directing The Future

A panel discussion with renowned film directors sharing their perspectives on the evolution of filming tools and techniques across music videos, films, series, and advertisements.

Panelists:

- Adam Juma,
 - Edwin Musiba,
 - Salum Majagi
 - Sama Jahanpour
- (Moderator)

Attendance **30**

Partners



8th July

Camera masterclass

The session explored different cameras, highlighting their strengths, limitations, and how shooting choices affect editing. It also covered editing tools, affordable options, and the need to meet international standards for broader markets.

Facilitator:

- Steve Aanu

Attendance **14**

Partners



Pre Festival Activities



9th July

Finding Fund for films

Masterclass by filmmaker Amil Shivji trained mid- to advanced-level directors and producers in pitching skills. Ten projects joined; eight teams completed, and five successfully pitched their work during the festival

Facilitator

- Amil Shivji
- Cece Mlay

Attendance **16**

Partners



9th & 10th July

Script writing (From story to script)

A two parts beginner-friendly workshop that guided participants on how to transform their stories into scripts.

Facilitator

- Hafsa J Salum

Attendance **36**

Partners



12th July

Introduction to Stop Animation

A two-part, beginner-friendly workshop that introduced participants to stop motion animation. Working in groups, they created short animations using simple props.

Facilitator:

- Alphonse Haule
- Nsiie Uiso

Attendance **18**

Partners



Pre Festival Activities



16th & 17th July

Advanced Script writing

A two part masterclass for intermediate and advanced scriptwriters, providing an opportunity to refine their skills and learn from internationally acclaimed writers.

Facilitator

- Dr. Mona Mwakalinga
- Adbul Simba

Attendance **18**

Partners



18th July

Film Critique and Review

A workshop on film analysis and critique, encouraging participants to go beyond entertainment by examining, critiquing, and learning from films.

Facilitator

- Jesse Gerard Mpango

Attendance **17**

Partners



23rd July

Film in Health

A session of screenings and discussions on Film for Health and Behaviour Change, highlighting the power of film to educate, inspire, and creatively deliver health messages that directly impact communities.

Invited Speaker

- Cecilia Lubango
- George Msuya
- Lateefa- Lilian Chuwa
- Hasaan Kiyungi
- Everbright Everready

Attendance **27**

Partners



Pre Festival Activities



24th & 25th July

Set design workshop

A two-day workshop on set design, covering the importance of sets in film, aligning design with scripts, and creatively using everyday props.

Facilitator

- Catherine Michael

Attendance **24**

Partners



25th July

Film Screening and Dialogue Kibasila secondary school

A half-day screening program for students, followed by discussions on their views of the film industry and analyses of key themes from the films, particularly women in leadership and the job market.

Facilitator

- Hassan Kiyungi,
- Faith Emmanuel,
- Charity King,
- Selemani Mohamed,
- Madam Wayanga Zyola

Attendance **232**

Partners



31st July - 16th August

Impact Film Lab

The Impact Film Lab trained producers, directors, and scriptwriters on using film to inspire change and influence social outcomes. Two teams received training, mentorship, and equipment support, and produced two short films.

Facilitator / Mentors:

- Hassan Kiyungi
- Khatibu Madudu
- Amini Suwedi
- Sama Jahanpour

Attendance **24**

Partners



Festival Activities



Panels & Forums



How to be a successful showrunner | Experience Sharing



Documentary Masterclass from Docubox



Film's contribution to the National Agendas



Ai in Film and the Future of Filmmaking



Presentations and Discussions from Distributors.



Film Pitch Session

Docubox Day



Docubox – The East African Documentary Film Fund

is a regional institution dedicated to supporting independent filmmakers and strengthening the documentary film ecosystem. Its participation at TAFFA highlighted the role of documentary film in shaping narratives and amplifying diverse voices in East Africa.

The program featured two sessions:

1. **Documentary Masterclass** facilitated by filmmaker Cece Mlay, followed by a case study presented by Kelvin Kagambo. Both of whom are beneficiaries of the Docubox Fund. The sessions provided participants with practical knowledge on the art and craft of documentary filmmaking as well as insights drawn from local practice



2. **Shorts, Shorts & Shots (SSS)**, Docubox's signature event. The audience came dressed in shorts, to view and discuss short films from Africa, while sipping shots (both alcoholic & non alcoholic). The program featured short film screenings accompanied by Q&A sessions, alongside music performances, social interactions, and networking opportunities, creating a platform for engagement between filmmakers, stakeholders, and audiences.



Attendance

378

Performances from: Dj Seche and Malaika Tarumbeta Band

MCs : Faith Emmanuel, Gertrude Mbela Alphonse Haule

Exhibitions

The Mashariki Creative Economy Expo featured over 60 booths showcasing film, art centres, fashion, and publishing. It provided a platform for creatives to connect and explore collaborations, with notable stakeholders including the Tanzania Film Board, CRDB Bank (administrator of the Art Fund), and prominent film series such as Dunia also exhibited

HIGHLIGHTS



Screenings

Over 437 films were submitted through Film Freeway and Film Festival Portal (tuzo.taffafestival.or.tz/) . After a review process with the Film Board, 30 films were selected for screening during the three-day festival. Additionally,

SELECTED FILMS

Uhuru Wangu by Muddy Sule
FIDI by Gwamaka Mwabuka
What Do You Say? by Kelvin Kagambo
Nafasi (The chance) by Sudi Mohamedi Masomwa
Hatua by Jasmin Munguti
Mundu Mpepho (The wind man) by David Kalala
Mapito by Mikidadi Mwinyijuma Mwinyiamani
Special kid by ponsiano Jonathan Ngumbulu
My Friend by Gwantwa Lucas Mwakalinga
Astahafirullah by Khamis Abdullah Jabir
NGWALE THE FALLEN LEGACY SHORT FILM by Mark Maganja Mark
FAHARI by Jenifer Kyaka
Bunji - Nuru ya Kawetere by Ramar King (Isarito Mwakalindile)
Msichana by Flavia Mmbando
WONDARLAND by Matthieu Nieto
SITUATIONSHIP by Simon Cherehani
KOMBOLELA SERIES by Abdul Usanga
JIVU SERIES by Abdul Usanga
DUNIA by Issa Madinga Jumanne
ZAWADI by Tom John Johns
UBANDA by HAFIDH ABEID (D'ZONGA CARLITO)
MZANI by INNOCENT JOSEPH
KIWEMBE by MATHEWS JOSEPH MK
INZALA by ALBERT VENANCE BONIPHACE
CHEMLI by SELEMAN ALLY KIWAMBA
KONIKUNYUMBA by FELIX MAHUNDI STEPHANO
RANSOM by DANIEL EDWARD MALE
ENG'OKI by HAFIDH ABEID(D'ZONGA CARLITO)
BARALUKO by SALIM AHMEDY ISSA
BOBO by MAURICE MUENDO



Film Pitching

5 Previously trained producer-director team pitched their film projects and received feedback from a panel of judges.



MEZA SAWA

Team Members:

- Tyatawelu Emmanuel,
- Juma Saada



**NGONO KWA SAMAKI
(FISH FOR SEX)**

Team Members:

- Joseph Kirati,
- Shafii Hamis



UKUNGU (FOG)

Team Members:

- Doreen Kilimbe,
- Martha John



UDHURUNGI (BROWN)

Team Members:

- Abdallah Fuad,
- Amos Kini



**MY MOTHER'S STORY
NOT MINE**

Team Members:

- Diana Senetor Lyoto

Judges



**PETER MUDAMBA
MUDAMBA**

General Manager :
Docubox



GRACE MGAYA

Public Relations
Specialist:
Multichoice



**WASIWASI
MWAMBULAMBO**

Head of Concept
Development at
Azam TV



SARAH B. ATHANAS

Digital Services
Executive: Vodacom
Tanzania

Emcee



HAIKAELI GILLIARD

Program Lead, Studio19



Winner

**Best Pitch at
TAFFA 2025**

UKUNGU (FOG)

Team Members:

- Doreen Kilimbe,
- Martha John

A man in a dark blue shirt and dark trousers stands on a stage, facing a seated audience. He is holding a microphone and gesturing with his left hand. The audience, consisting of men and women of various ages, is seated at long wooden tables. The room has large windows with vertical blinds in the background. The floor is covered with a patterned carpet. The overall atmosphere is professional and focused.

Strategic Impact & Way Forward

Strategic Impact

The joint platform created by TAFFA and the Mashariki Expo demonstrated that Tanzania's creative industries are not just about entertainment—they are engines of economic growth, social cohesion, and cultural diplomacy.

Cross-Sector Synergies

The collaboration linked film, technology, fashion, design, and media, enabling creatives to explore new markets and collaborations. This synergy established Tanzania as a regional meeting point for diverse industries.

Business and Investment Opportunities

Through B2B engagements, networking sessions, and industry dialogues, the Festival opened doors for producers, distributors, investors, and entrepreneurs. Discussions on co-productions, distribution platforms, and financing models laid the foundation for more sustainable creative enterprises.

Cultural Diplomacy & Regional Leadership

Hosting participants from across Africa and beyond, the Festival amplified Tanzania's profile as a leader in storytelling and creative innovation, reinforcing cultural ties and positioning Dar es Salaam as a gateway for regional collaboration.

Youth and Talent Empowerment

Young filmmakers, emerging artists, and creative entrepreneurs found mentorship, exposure, and practical opportunities. By spotlighting new voices, the Festival nurtured a pipeline of talent ready to contribute to the nation's creative economy.



Looking Ahead

The Tanzania Film Festival & Awards is not just an annual celebration, it's a platform to unlock long-term growth for Tanzania's creative economy. Moving forward, we are committed to building a stronger ecosystem for filmmakers through strategic partnerships.

1. Training & Capacity Building

- Collaborate with **universities, film schools, and cultural institutions** (locally and internationally).
- Launch **year-round training labs** and **masterclasses** in directing, screenwriting, producing, and emerging fields like animation and AI in film.
- Empower 200+ young filmmakers annually with practical skills to compete on regional and global stages.

2. Funding & Investment Access

- Work with **development agencies, film funds, and financial institutions** to create dedicated funding pipelines.
- Facilitate **pitch forums** and **investor meet-ups** that connect Tanzanian filmmakers with African and global financiers.
- Position sponsors as enablers of a sustainable creative economy that generates jobs and returns.

3. Distribution & Global Reach

- Partner with regional broadcasters, OTT platforms, and international distributors to showcase Tanzanian films to wider audiences.
- Expand screenings to diaspora communities and global cultural showcases.
- Brand partners gain exposure across multiple geographies, extending visibility far beyond Tanzania.

To Partners & Sponsors

Join the Awards Now:

Be part of the Tanzania Film Awards – December 6, 2025. Secure your sponsorship today and showcase your brand alongside the very best of Tanzanian cinema.

✉ taffaawards@studio19.co.tz

Co-Design TAFFA 2026:

Shape the future of the festival with us. Early partners enjoy category exclusivity, premium visibility, and a seat at the table as we build TAFFA 2026.

✉ taffaprogram@studio19.co.tz

Sustain the Movement:

Align with a year-round cultural platform that inspires, educates, and empowers communities through film and creativity. Be recognised as a long-term champion of transformation.

✉ taffafestival@studio19.co.tz

Or Reach us through

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